

**University of the Philippines
School of Library and Information Science**

**LIS 60
Organization of Information**

Activity 1

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A timeline of the development of the catalog and cataloging codes based from the article by Strout (1956) titled "The Development of the Catalog and Cataloging Codes"

Circa 2000 B.C.: The Sumerian tablet is found at Nippur, which represents the oldest known lists of book, recording sixty-two titles, including twenty-four known literary works.

Circa 1400 B.C.: The Amarna tablets are excavated in Egypt. It contains early references to books, specifically small plaques featuring the names of the king and queen alongside book titles, likely serving as ownership or identification tags.

Circa 1300 B.C.: The excavated Hittite tablets provide the earliest evidence of colophons used for bibliographical information, featuring subscripts that identified a tablet's number in a series, its title, and often the name of the scribe.

Circa 650 B.C.: The library or archives of the Assyrian king, Ashurbanipal, at Ninevah utilized elaborate colophons recording titles, volume numbering, and stamps of royal ownership to ensure order and authenticity.

Circa 300 B.C. (3rd and 2nd Centuries B.C.): The Temple at Edfu features catalogs of books carved directly onto its walls, signaling a move toward permanent, public facing records of holdings.

Circa 250 B.C.: Callimachus compiled his Pinakes at the Alexandrian Library which introduced author entries and recorded line counts, a bibliography for Greek literature.

529: No significant happenings to add to the history of cataloging.

Circa 730 (8th Century): The earliest listing of the holdings of medieval library appears as a brief inventory of titles recorded on the final flyleaf of a volume, with authors appended to only a few titles.

9th Century: Two libraries are mentioned to have produced catalogs more outstanding than those of the general run.

822-842: The library at Reichanau in Germany demonstrated an early classified order, grouping works by author or category.

831: The inventory of Benedictine house of St. Requier was compiled at the request of Louis le Debonnaire, serving as a literal accounting of 246 volumes.

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10th Century: Libraries had grown considerably in size. However, no significant improvements in cataloging.

11th -12th Century: No improvements and less information recorded in the list on these two centuries.

13th Century: There is an attempt at a Union List of holdings for English libraries.

1247: A catalog from the Library of Glastonbury Abbey employed a number of unusual descriptions when designating its books.

Late 13th Century: *Registrum Librorum Angliae* was compiled as an early union list of English monastic library holdings and employed symbols to identify individual libraries.

14th Century: The concept of location symbols emerged, alongside more complete identification of editions and entries for multiple works contained within a single volume.

1310: The Christ Church, Canterbury list demonstrates a sophisticated arrangement by numbered sections and shelves, establishing a fixed-location system.

1327: The Exeter Cathedral inventory records the opening words and prices of volumes, illustrating the catalog's dual role as a finding aid and financial record.

1372: The Augustinian friars' list at York shows a radical shift toward classified subject arrangement, separating an author's works when their subjects dictated a different placement.

1389: The St. Martin's Priory catalog at Dover is the first justly designated a "catalog" because it included analytical entries for multiple works within a single volume and used specific call numbers.

15th Century: Cross-references, compilation of bibliography, and an index to the bibliography emerged.

1410: John Boston of Bury's catalog continued and revised the *Registrum*, utilizing the same institutional code numbers for English monastery holdings.

1410-1412: The catalog of Amplonius Ratnick de Berka introduced a primitive use of cross-references, appended to contents notes to direct readers to other volumes

1490: St. Augustine's Abbey in Canterbury compiled a catalog in which cross-references reappeared, serving an analytical function and attaining the status of full entries.

1494: Johann Trithem's *Liber de scriptoribus ecclesiasticis* utilized the first alphabetical author index, a revolutionary retrieval device appended to a chronological bibliography.

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16th Century: A catalog was produced that recorded translators, editors, and bibliographies, with particular attention given to the entry word for the first time.

1524: The Syon Monastery catalog appeared as a classified catalog featuring an alphabetical author index, merging medieval and modern techniques.

1545: Konrad Gesner's *Bibliotheca universalis* standardized author bibliographies and introduced the practice of name inversion.

1548: Konrad Gesner's *Pandectarum* suggested that libraries use his printed bibliographies as their own catalogs by simply marking their specific holdings.

1558: The Priory of Bretton catalog provided the first known inclusion of editors and translators within bibliographic entries.

1560: Florian Trefler's treatise advocated a five-part catalog system and a classification scheme that even utilized binding colors for call numbers.

1595: Andrew Maunsell's *Catalogue of English Printed Books* established the radical rule of entry under surnames rather than Christian names.

17th Century: There was a growing interest in catalogs, along with treatises on their proper compilation. This period focused more on consolidating past achievements than on generating new ideas.

Early 1600s: Sir Thomas Bodley's code for the Oxford University Library insisted on entry by family names and the inclusion of analytical entries. Moreover, Gabriel Naudé's *Avis pour dresser une bibliothèque* recommended divided catalogs, separating subject and author entries for better retrieval.

1697: Humphrey Wanley identified a list of cataloging desiderata for the Bodleian, such as recording publisher names and book sizes. Also, Frederic Rostgaard's *Projet d'une nouvelle méthode* proposed a complex arrangement of four parallel columns based on subject, size, and chronology.

18th Century: The same course was followed as in the 17th century, with the exception of its last decades, when the French government adopted card catalogs.

1791: The French National Code established the first national standard and introduced the card catalog; due to wartime shortages, it used playing cards, with instructions to underline the author's surname as the filing word and reserve "aces and deuces" for the longest titles.

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19th Century: There was a keen interest in catalogs, accompanied by significantly increased demands from library users.

1827: Thomas Hartwell Horne's *A Catalogue... Methodically Arranged* insisted on the then-novel principle that a single book could have multiple subject entries.

1831: Anthony Panizzi was appointed to the British Museum, marking the start of the modern era through his insistence on rigorous, rule-based organization.

1836: A select committee was appointed by the House of Commons "to inquire into the condition, management, and affairs of the British Museum".

1839: The "91 Rules" were approved for the British Museum, becoming the first major modern cataloging code.

1847: A further investigation of the British Museum was deemed necessary, and the Crown appointed the Commission to inquire into the Constitution and Government of the British Museum.

March 9, 1849: Earl of Ellesmere questioned if each book should be catalogued under the form of the name appearing on the title.

1850: Charles C. Jewett's code for the Smithsonian Institution established the principle of the corporate author and the "stringency" of rules to eliminate individual judgment.

1876: Charles Cutter's *Rules for a Printed Dictionary Catalogue* defined the catalog's role in assembling "literary units," ensuring all versions of a work appear together.

1893: William Coolidge Lane identified "settled points" in practice, such as the use of the vernacular for author names, at the World's Library Congress.

1904: Lane's report at the St. Louis international meeting noted the definitive victory of the card catalog over printed forms and a trend toward increasingly detailed codes.